Eli's Reading Practice

Level 2 (about 4.0 grade level) • Words from Vowel Sounds /u/, /yoo/, /oo/
Read each passage carefully, then answer the questions. Use the passage to find evidence for your answers.

The Crew of the Blue Comet

(fiction)

Ava, Jamal, and Theo called themselves the crew of the Blue Comet, the robot they had built for the science fair. Two days before the fair, the robot's arm got stuck halfway up and refused to move. Jamal thought the battery was weak, but Theo was sure a wire had come loose. Soon the two boys began to argue so loudly that Ava covered her ears. "Arguing won't fix anything," she said firmly. "Let's test each idea, one at a time." First, they replaced the battery, but the arm stayed frozen. Next, they checked every wire and used a tiny brush to clear away dust. Under the motor, Theo discovered a cookie crumb wedged between the gears. Everyone burst out laughing, including Jamal. After they removed the crumb, the arm swung smoothly into the air. At the fair, the Blue Comet played a tune on a toy xylophone, and the judges were amused. The crew learned that trust and patience can solve problems that arguing never will.

Questions

1. What is the main idea of this story?

a) A team fixes their robot by testing ideas calmly instead of arguing.
b) A robot wins first prize at a fair.
c) Two boys stop being friends.
d) Cookies are bad for robots.

2. What was wedged between the gears?

a) a loose wire
b) a cookie crumb
c) a dead battery
d) a paintbrush

3. Why did Ava cover her ears?

a) The robot was beeping.
b) The boys were arguing loudly.
c) Music was playing.
d) She was cold.

4. "A cookie crumb wedged between the gears." What does wedged mean?

a) stuck tightly
b) melted
c) painted
d) floating

5. Which sentence shows Ava had a plan?

a) "Arguing won't fix anything," she said firmly. "Let's test each idea, one at a time."
b) Everyone burst out laughing, including Jamal.
c) Jamal thought the battery was weak, but Theo was sure a wire had come loose.
d) At the fair, the Blue Comet played a tune on a toy xylophone, and the judges were amused.

6. What did the crew try first?

a) checking the wires
b) replacing the battery
c) brushing the gears
d) asking a teacher

7. What caused the robot's arm to get stuck?

a) a weak battery
b) a loose wire
c) a crumb in the gears
d) dust on the wheels

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

refused: _____

argue: _____

firmly: _____

wedged: _____

patience: _____

Rescue at Sea

(nonfiction)

When a boat is in trouble far from shore, the United States Coast Guard is often the first to respond. Coast Guard crews rescue thousands of people every year. Rescuers train for months before they are ready for a real emergency. A rescue swimmer must be strong enough to swim through huge waves while wearing a heavy suit. The suit keeps the swimmer warm in freezing water. During a rescue, helicopters and boats work together. First, the crew finds the boat using radio signals and GPS. Next, a helicopter hovers above the water and lowers a rescue swimmer on a cable. The swimmer helps people into a metal basket, and the basket is pulled up into the helicopter. Because every second matters, crews practice these steps until they can do them quickly. People who go boating can help, too. They should always wear life jackets and tell someone on land where they are going. These simple steps make it easier for rescuers to find them.

Questions

1. What is this passage mostly about?

a) how the Coast Guard rescues people at sea
b) how to build a boat
c) why the ocean is cold
d) how helicopters fly

2. What does the rescue swimmer's suit do?

a) helps them fly
b) keeps them warm in freezing water
c) makes them float to shore
d) sends radio signals

3. Why should boaters tell someone on land where they are going?

a) so rescuers know where to look if there is trouble
b) so they can get a prize
c) so the boat goes faster
d) so they don't need life jackets

4. "A helicopter hovers above the water." What does hovers mean?

a) stays in one place in the air
b) crashes
c) lands
d) flies away fast

5. Which sentence tells you why crews practice so much?

a) Because every second matters, crews practice these steps until they can do them quickly.
b) People who go boating can help, too.
c) Coast Guard crews rescue thousands of people every year.
d) The suit keeps the swimmer warm in freezing water.

6. What happens right after the helicopter lowers the swimmer?

a) The crew finds the boat with GPS.
b) The swimmer helps people into a metal basket.
c) The boaters put on life jackets.
d) The crew trains for months.

7. What is one effect of boaters wearing life jackets and sharing their plans?

a) Rescuers can find them more easily.
b) The waves get smaller.
c) The water gets warmer.
d) They never need help.

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

respond: _____

emergency: _____

signals: _____

hovers: _____

cable: _____

Answer Key (for grown-ups)

The Crew of the Blue Comet

1. a) A team fixes their robot by testing ideas calmly instead of arguing. [Main idea]
2. b) a cookie crumb [Details]
3. b) The boys were arguing loudly. [Inference]
4. a) stuck tightly [Vocabulary in context]
5. a) “Arguing won't fix anything,” she said firmly. “Let's test each idea, one at a time.” [Evidence]
6. b) replacing the battery [Sequence]
7. c) a crumb in the gears [Cause & effect]

Vocab: refused = would not do something; argue = to disagree in an angry way; firmly = in a strong, sure way; wedged = stuck tightly into a small space; patience = staying calm while you wait or work on something hard

Rescue at Sea

1. a) how the Coast Guard rescues people at sea [Main idea]
2. b) keeps them warm in freezing water [Details]
3. a) so rescuers know where to look if there is trouble [Inference]
4. a) stays in one place in the air [Vocabulary in context]
5. a) Because every second matters, crews practice these steps until they can do them quickly. [Evidence]
6. b) The swimmer helps people into a metal basket. [Sequence]
7. a) Rescuers can find them more easily. [Cause & effect]

Vocab: respond = to answer or act when something happens; emergency = a sudden, dangerous situation that needs help fast; signals = messages sent by sound, light, or radio; hovers = stays in one place in the air; cable = a thick, strong rope made of wire